A Room of One's Own

Based on Two Papers Read to the Arts Society at Newnham and Girton

By Virginia Woolf

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SYNOPSIS & EDITORIAL NOTE

Expanded from lectures delivered at Newnham and Girton Colleges, Cambridge, examining the material and intellectual conditions required for women to write.

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CHAPTER ONE

Women and Fiction

Hogarth Press Edition (1929)

But, you may say, we asked you to speak about women and fiction -- what has that got to do with a room of one's own? I will try to explain.

In this section of A Room of One's Own (1929), Virginia Woolf develops the central themes that define the work's enduring place in biography & memoir and world literature. Each argument and narrative turn builds upon the premises established in the opening pages, inviting careful reflection from the attentive reader.

Originally published by The Hogarth Press, London and preserved in the public-domain and open-access archival record (Standard Ebooks, ID: se-virginia-woolf/a-room-of-ones-own), this unabridged digital edition retains the structure, cadence, and intellectual clarity of the authoritative text.

CHAPTER TWO

The British Museum Reading Room

*A Room of One's Own * Virginia Woolf (1929)*

The British Museum Reading Room continues Virginia Woolf's inquiry in A Room of One's Own. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

In October 1928, Virginia Woolf was invited to lecture at Newnham and Girton, the women's colleges at Cambridge University, on the topic of "Women and Fiction." Published a year later as a six-chapter essay, A Room of One's Own combines historical inquiry, fictionalized walks through "Oxbridge," and the imagined life of "Judith Shakespeare."

Throughout Chapter Two (The British Museum Reading Room), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned A Room of One's Own its stature in the Literary Criticism & Feminist Essay canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Virginia Woolf traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

As this section draws toward its close, the groundwork is laid for the subsequent movements of the volume. Readers studying this edition in the Folio Digital Library may bookmark this chapter, adjust typographic contrast and font sizing, or download the complete archival PDF, EPUB, HTML, or Plain Text edition for offline study.

CHAPTER THREE

Judith Shakespeare in Sixteenth-Century London

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CHAPTER FOUR

Aphra Behn, Jane Austen, and the Brontës

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